DO NOW — RECALL

Lesson 157 · Data Protection: OCR's 1998 Act and Today

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

1. Why must a server validate data sent by a browser?

2. What is the purpose of an operating system's memory management?

3. What is the worst-case order of binary search?

4. Why does the TLS padlock not guarantee a site is honest?

DO NOW — CHECK / OBJECTIVES

Correct and improve

Check page 1 in GREEN PEN. Write corrections in full.

1. Model answer

Client-side checks can be bypassed, so authoritative checks belong on the server.

2. Model answer

Allocating and protecting memory for running programs.

3. Model answer

O(log n) on sorted random-access data.

4. Model answer

Encryption in transit does not establish trustworthiness of operator.

By the end, you can…

• DPA 1998 protected living people's personal data; OCR names this Act in 1.5.1.

• DPA 2018 and UK GDPR now form the core UK regime; later legislation amends it.

• Purpose, minimisation, accuracy, security and lawful handling matter in a school.

• Distinguish lawful data handling from the ethical risks of automated decisions, monitoring and analysing pupil information.

Vocabulary — know these terms

personal data — Information relating to an identified or identifiable living person.

data minimisation — Collect only data necessary for a specified purpose.

controller — Organisation deciding purposes and means of processing.

UK GDPR — Current UK data protection regulatory framework alongside DPA 2018.

NEW LEARNING

Read, annotate and explain

OCR historic focus

DPA 1998 protected living people's personal data; OCR names this Act in 1.5.1.

Current framework

DPA 2018 and UK GDPR now form the core UK regime; later legislation amends it.

Apply principles

Purpose, minimisation, accuracy, security and lawful handling matter in a school. OCR 1.5.2 also asks for ethical judgement : monitoring and analysing personal data may be permitted in particular circumstances yet still introduce bias, unjustified intrusion or harmful automated decisions.

Explain one step in your own words, using the correct technical terms.

I DO — WORKED EXAMPLE

Follow the worked method

A school stores student medical notes alongside general attendance records and permits every staff member to open them. Identify data-protection issues.

Identify sensitive data

Identify the relevant facts, purpose and authority.

Restrict justified access

Discuss which law or safeguard fits the situation.

Secure, minimise and review

Medical information is sensitive personal data with stronger protections. Restrict access by legitimate role, use a proper lawful basis and relevant special-category condition, minimise collected fields, keep information accurate and protect access. DPA 1998 is named historically by OCR but current UK law is DPA 2018/UK GDPR.

Inspect before predicting

Missing registration entries are not necessarily absences. An automated score based on incomplete records can be inaccurate. Analyse how data were collected, not only the calculated result.

Bias, monitoring and transparency

Continuous pupil monitoring may be intrusive and disadvantage some groups if context is ignored. A system must have a proportionate purpose, access safeguards and a meaningful way to question errors.

Human review before action

No automatic sanction. Check original entries, pupil circumstances and the model’s limitations; use verified information for supportive intervention. Compliance with data protection law alone does not guarantee an ethically fair decision.

WE DO — GUIDED PRACTICE

Try → Discuss → Improve

YOU DO — INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Questions · Part 1

Answer independently. Show code, calculations, a trace or justified reasoning as appropriate.

Question 1

State three obligations or principles associated with protecting personal data, applied to a school. [6]

Question 2

Explain the distinction between OCR naming the Data Protection Act 1998 and the modern UK data-protection framework. [6]

YOU DO — INDEPENDENT PRACTICE

Questions · Part 2

Answer independently. Show code, calculations, a trace or justified reasoning as appropriate.

Question 3

A school proposes publicly sharing a named student progress spreadsheet and automatically sanctioning pupils flagged by an AI model trained on incomplete attendance records. Evaluate legal and ethical risks. [8]

EXIT TICKET / REFLECTION

Check your understanding

Complete the actual lesson Exit Ticket before checking the answer.

The Data Protection Act 1998 remains the UK's principal current data protection law.

How confident are you? Circle one: Confident / Getting there / Need help

Explain your choice, identifying one concept you can now use independently.

GREEN PEN — Correct and explain

Choose one mistake from your independent work. Write the correct method and explain precisely why your original answer was wrong.

Next step: revisit the model or a relevant revision-guide section if needed.